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Classroom Assignment Sheet

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Question - what were the key political factors that led to the decline of Mughal empire, and how did they contribute to the shift in power dynamics in the Indian subcontinent?

The decline of Mughal empire initiated the shift in power dynamics of Indian subcontinent which followed a domino effect ^{into} causing the disintegration of Mughal India, ~~rise of~~ regional powers and finally ended up being one of the biggest colonies of English.

Political factors of decline

- 1) No clear line of succession in Later mughals leading to a political instability which allowed 6 rulers to be appointed in just 12 years.
- 2) Invasions of Nadir Shah, Ahmad Shah Abdali led to the drain of Mughal wealth.
- 3) Later mughals were weak as they traded "power" in exchange of themselves ascending to the throne. As a result, it was the mughal nobility taking decisions in the name of mughal emperors.

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48 The shift in power dynamics causing domino effect leading to a faster decline of Mughals

Asaf Jah defeating the Governors of Hyderabad ↓

Est. of autonomous state of Hyderabad ↓

Carnatic becomes free from the legal purview of Mughal Empire. ↓

War of Succession in Carnatic leading to the interference of European powers in the native politics of India.

5 The Royal Charter of 1717 intentionally allowed British expansion in India.

The Mughal nobles like Zulfikar Khan, Saiyyad brothers Asaf Jah played a decisive role in the fragmentation of Mughal polity but the root cause traces back to the "Weak and incapable later Mughals" post 1707.

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